



ARTIST'S IMPRESSION: CONCEPTUAL VISION FOR THE FUTURE RE- DEVELOPMENT OF BALL PARK CARAVAN PARK

Submission Deadline: 26th June, 2026

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST -

2026 – 305 - For the Re-Development and Management of
Ball Park Caravan Park, Corowa, NSW

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1. Introduction

The Opportunity: A New Chapter for Corowa

Federation Council is proud to invite Expressions of Interest (EOIs) from visionary, high calibre operators for the management and strategic redevelopment of the Ball Park Caravan Park.

Located on the pristine foreshore of the iconic Murray River in Corowa, this site represents one of the region's most significant tourism assets, now primed for a transformation into a premier Australian destination.

This is more than a long lease; it is a unique opportunity to collaborate with Council in shaping a contemporary, sustainable, and commercially viable holiday park.

Council seeks an innovative partner with the proven capability to unlock the site's potential and deliver contemporary infrastructure that reflects the evolving expectations of the modern traveler.

Why Ball Park?

Ball Park Caravan Park represents an exceptional opportunity to serve as a cornerstone of regional tourism, anchored by its direct, picturesque frontage onto a premier and highly accessible section of the iconic Murray River. Its strategic location offers a unique blend of accessibility and leisure, sitting just a comfortable 3-hour and 15-minute drive from the Melbourne metropolitan market.

Step into the heart of Corowa, a town where significant Australian history meets a vibrant modern lifestyle. Known as the "Birthplace of Federation," Corowa offers a rich tapestry of heritage trails and grand architecture that now houses award-winning whisky distilleries and artisan chocolate makers. Beyond the town center the surrounding region opens up into a gourmet goldmine; here, century-old vineyards and farm-gate stalls invite guests to taste the very best of the harvest.

For the active traveler, Ball Park is perfectly positioned within a high-value recreation precinct. Guests can spend their days cycling along scenic trails that connect historic villages or take to the water for a peaceful paddle by the iconic river red gums. With world-class fishing spots, bird filled wetlands, and plenty of room to roam, the region provides the perfect backdrop for outdoor adventure. Corowa's proximity to the renowned Indigo and King Valley wine regions and its location less than two hours from world-class ski fields make Ball Park an ideal year-round destination for a diverse range of travellers.

The activation of this park is a primary economic driver for Corowa and the wider Federation region. Following strategic remediation, the park currently operates on a reduced footprint, leaving a significant portion including highly valued foreshore areas as a blank canvas for development. Both the community and the Council share a high ambition to elevate the park's profile, enrich the visitor journey, and contribute meaningfully to the long-term economic and social vitality of the region.

2. A Secure, Long-Term Partnership

This EOI is conducted under the Local Government Act 1993 (NSW) and the Crown Land Management Act 2016. Council is offering a secure foundation for investment with the following tenure options:

21-Year Initial Lease: A robust term to support significant infrastructure delivery.

30-Year Potential: Council is actively pursuing Ministerial approval for an extended 30-year lease to provide further commercial certainty. Council is currently undertaking the necessary Plan of Management requirements and agency consultations to facilitate this.

Proponent Requirement: Proponents must clearly indicate within their proposal whether they are seeking the standard 21-year lease, a 30-year lease, or if their proposal is contingent only upon the longer 30-year period.

IMPORTANT NOTICE: Please note that the potential 30-year tenure is subject to formal Ministerial approval and is not guaranteed at this stage. Proponents should structure their capital investment plans and business models to remain viable based on the 21-year term, treating the 30-year extension as a strategic opportunity.

3. Key Dates

Expression of Interest Open	Friday 15 th May, 2026
Questions to be submitted prior to Site Inspection	Wednesday 27 th May, 2026
Formal Site Inspection	Wednesday 3 rd June, 2026
Final Questions to be submitted prior to EOI closure	Wednesday 17 th June, 2026
Expression of Interest Period Closed	Friday 26 th June, 2026
Assessment of EOI's – invites for detailed proposals	Week 13 th – 17 th July 2026

4. Site Overview and Context

Regional Context

Corowa is a substantial and historically significant river town that serves as a key service centre for the productive agricultural lands flanking the Murray River. The district supports a diverse mix of farming activities, including broad acre and irrigated cropping, livestock, and significant value adding agricultural businesses including dairy, pork, pet food and cereal production. These are complemented by a range of supporting industries.

The region is also a prominent tourism destination, offering recreational activities on the Murray River and Lake Mulwala, with convenient access to internationally recognised wineries and the snow fields.

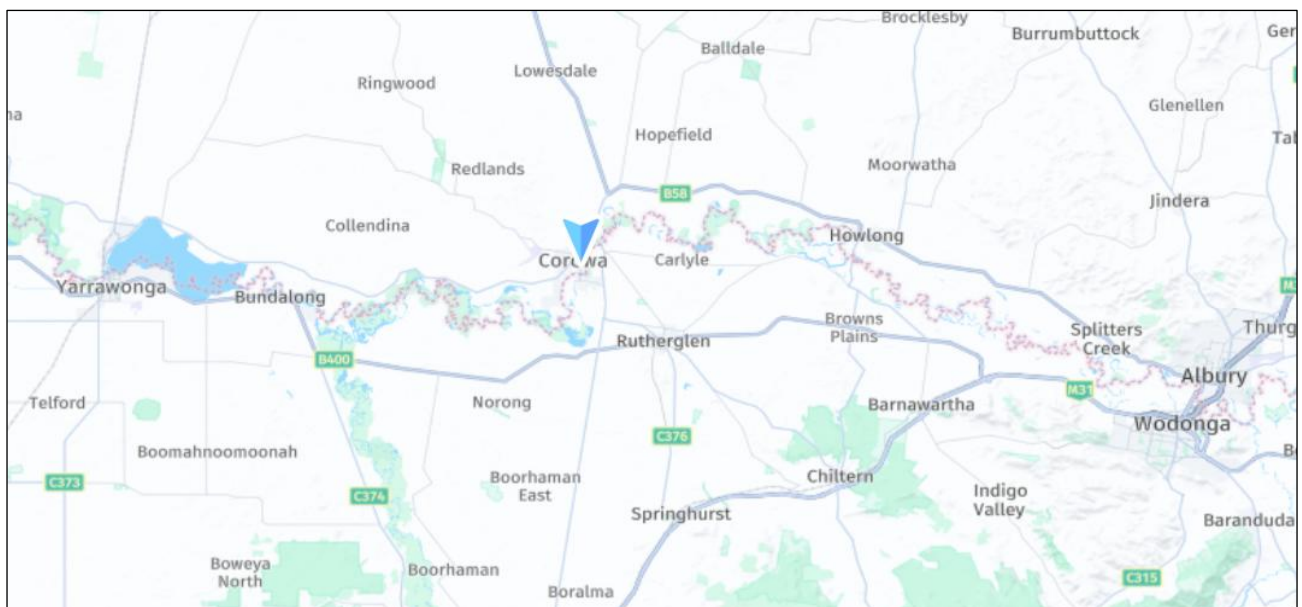


FIGURE 1: SITE LOCATION REGIONAL CONTEXT

Physical Description and Land Status

Ball Park Caravan Park occupies approximately 8 hectares of land, comprising both Crown land (Reserve No. 80910 for Public Recreation, managed by Council) and Council-owned land (refer to Figure 2).

The area available for lease comprising the existing caravan park and overflow area as shown in Figure 2 is delineated by the pink outline.

This site consists of both Crown Land (orange shading) and Federation Council-owned land (blue shading), as detailed in Figure 3. The site is divided into two primary zones:

- **Operational Footprint (Yellow Shading):** The currently active area utilised for visitor accommodation.
- **Potential Expansion Area (Pink Shading):** A premium riverfront section requiring further development assessment to be formalised for full-time use (referred to as the Overflow Area).



FIGURE 2: CARAVAN PARK AREAS - EXISTING CARAVAN PARK AND OVERFLOW AREA

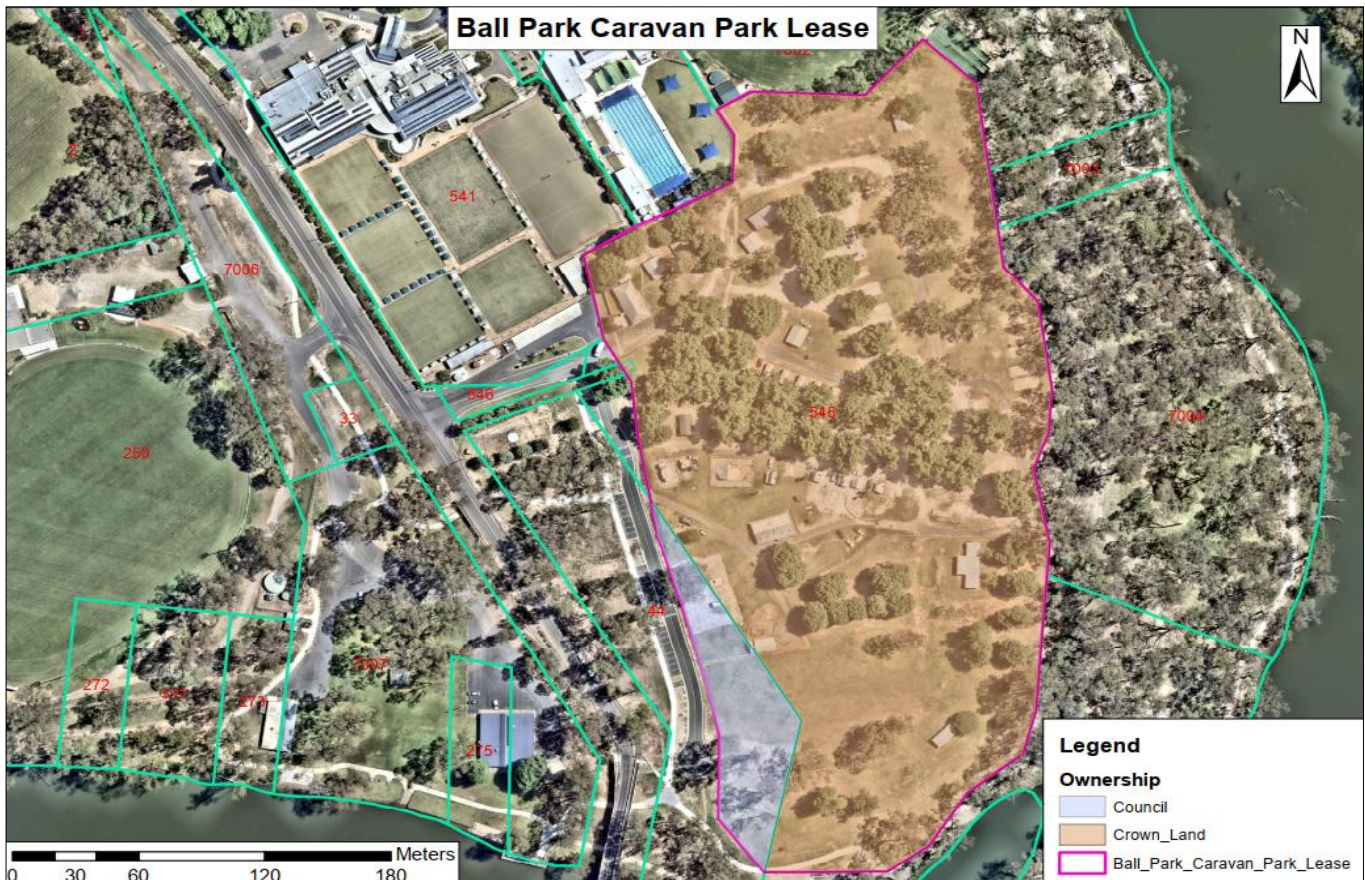


FIGURE 3: BALL PARK CARAVAN PARK OWNERSHIP

Management History and Strategic Remediation

Following the conclusion of previous long-term lease arrangements, Council assumed direct management of the park. Between 2019 and 2020, Council undertook a significant remediation program to resolve legacy compliance risks including electrical, waste-water, and fire safety, resulting in the removal of approximately 180 non-compliant annual vans and cabins.

The Park now operates on a reduced, fully compliant footprint via a labour-management model. While this has provided essential accommodation in the interim, Council has successfully navigated the challenges of the remediation, the 2022 floods, and the pandemic to prepare the site as a "blank canvas" ready for professional redevelopment.

Strategic Context and Precinct Investment

In October 2020, Council adopted a comprehensive Masterplan which identifies the "Pink Shaded" area as Stage 1 of the redevelopment (refer to overflow area in figure 2 above). This area is designated for high-class, elevated short-stay cabins designed to capitalise on extensive Murray River views.

The future development of the park including any proposal to formalise the full-time use of the overflow area, will be the sole responsibility of the incoming lessee. The incoming lessee will be entirely responsible

for sourcing, preparing and obtaining all required plans and specifications and development consents and any other regulatory approvals.

Council has not been able to issue a Section 68 approval for the overflow area without a design to allow assessment against the design.

Proponents to this EOI are strongly advised to ensure they have a clear and comprehensive understanding of the development application process, applicable planning controls, and all regulatory approval pathways relevant to the development proposals included in their submission.

The commercial appeal of the park is further enhanced by over \$15 million in recent infrastructure investment in the immediate precinct, including:

- The \$12 million year-round Corowa Aquatic Centre.
- Over 5km of concrete pathways and regional walking trails.
- Upgraded river access roads, parking, and extensive landscaping.
- Restoration of historic assets, including a red brick well and new public shelter areas.



Current Operational Approval (ATO)

The Park operates under a Section 68 (Part F2) Approval to Operate (ATO) for a total of 139 sites:

- **Short-term sites:** 20 total (comprising 16 Council-owned cabins and 4 villa-standard cabins).
- **Camping sites:** 123 total (including 97 powered sites).
- **Special Events:** Condition 6 allows for an additional 30 temporary sites for 7 days annually for the KVE gathering – refer to "Pink Shaded" area "overflow area" in figure 2 above.

Existing Facilities and Built Assets

- **Amenities:** Four amenity blocks (variable condition), camp kitchen, and barbecue shelters.
- **Operational:** Office/kiosk and manager's residence.
- **Council-Owned Cabins:** 20 cabins (C1-C20) ranging from budget to villa standard. Council expects a financial return on these assets, valued at over \$500,000. Proponents must indicate if they wish to purchase or lease these as part of their offer.

Current Rates and Tariffs

The current rates and tariffs for stays at Ball Park Caravan Park are outlined in below table and are accurate as of the date of this Expression of Interest. All rates are quoted for two persons per booking.

	Low	Mid	Peak
Villa Unit	\$162.00	\$175.00	\$199.00
Executive Unit	\$152.00	\$165.00	\$189.00
Standard Plus Unit	\$136.00	\$149.00	\$178.00
Standard Unit	\$126.00	\$139.00	\$168.00
Budget Unit	\$120.00	\$135.00	\$157.00
Powered Site	\$42.00	\$46.00	\$52.00
Unpowered Site	\$32.00	\$38.00	\$42.00

For units (cabins):

- Additional adults: \$20 per night
- Additional children: \$15 per night

For camping sites:

- Additional adults: \$15 per night
- Additional children: \$12 per night

These rates are provided for reference only and may be subject to change. Proponents are encouraged to consider current pricing structures when developing their commercial proposals.

5. EOI Strategic Objectives

Council seeks to engage a capable operator who can:

- Deliver a high-quality, compliant, and commercially viable park operation that meets contemporary visitor expectations and regulatory obligations.
- Identify and pursue redevelopment opportunities that unlock the potential of the site and support long-term strategic growth.
- Maintain the current park operations whilst developing the currently vacant unapproved section/s to continue to provide an important accommodation option.
- Enhance accommodation offerings and increase visitation, with a focus on diversified product mix, seasonal activation, and market responsiveness.
- Prepare a comprehensive development plan outlining proposed capital investment, staging, and alignment with planning and environmental (regulatory) frameworks.
- Elevate the visitor experience and tourism value through improved amenities, service standards, and integration with regional attractions.
- Ensure ongoing compliance with relevant environmental, planning and Crown land management requirements, including obligations under the Local Government Act and other relevant legislation.
- Consider implementation of innovative, eco-friendly initiatives—such as solar energy integration, advanced water recycling systems, and robust waste reduction strategies

6. Procurement Process

Federation Council has decided to utilise the selective tender method pursuant to section 166(b) of the Local Government (General) Regulations. Council will conduct the procurement process using E Procure via <https://www.federationcouncil.nsw.gov.au/Council/Tendering-Supply> in three progressive stages:

Stage 1 -

Expression of Interest (EOI):

Initial submissions are invited from suitably qualified and experienced operators outlining their capability, vision, and alignment with Council's strategic objectives for the Ball Park Caravan Park.

Stage 2 -

Selective Tender - Request for Detailed Proposals (RDP):

All proponents from Stage 1 will be assessed and following a Council determination via a confidential Council meeting, Council will invite the final selected proponent/s to submit comprehensive proposals detailing their operational approach, development concepts, financial models, and compliance strategies.

**Further detailed criteria will be provided at this time to the selected proponents*.*

Stage 3 -

Negotiation:

Council will then assess the final tender/s submitted, and via a Council determination resolve to accept a tender or refuse tender/s submitted.

Council has various means under the Local Government Act at this time to proceed further depending on the outcomes of this process, including entering into negotiations with one or more shortlisted proponents to refine proposals, clarify commitments, and establish a pathway to a partnership.

Council reserves the right to proceed to Stages 2 and 3 with one or more selected proponents at its discretion.

7. Scope of Proposal - Stage 1: Expression of Interest (EOI)

Proponents are required to address the following five criteria in their EOI submission:

In this initial stage, Proponents are required to provide a high-level conceptual overview and demonstrate their ability to deliver a premier tourism asset. Submissions should focus on the following:

1. Capacity and Previous Experience

- Provide an overview of the proponent's history in the caravan park, hospitality, or tourism sector.
- Demonstrate a proven track record of managing similar-scale assets or successful delivery of caravan park re-development projects.
- Provide references or case studies of current or past operations that align with the strategic objectives for Ball Park.

2. Vision and Accommodation Concept

- Outline the high-level vision for the park's transformation.
- Propose an indicative accommodation mix (e.g., glamping, cabins, campsites) that aligns with modern tourism trends and market demand.
- Identify the target visitor segments the proponent intends to attract.

3. Preliminary Development Approach

- Present a conceptual "look and feel" for the park's future state.
- Provide high-level thoughts on staging and how the park can transition from its current footprint to a fully activated precinct.

4. Indicative Guest Experience

- Outline the philosophy behind the proposed guest services and communal facilities.
- Identify potential commercial activities (e.g., café, equipment hire) that could enhance the visitor journey / experience.

5. High-Level Financial and Term Preferences

- Specify the preferred initial lease term and any high-level requirements for the commercial model to ensure project viability.

8. Evaluation Criteria – Stage 1: - Expression of Interest (EOI)

The following criteria will be used to evaluate Expression of Interest (EOI) submissions to determine a shortlist of Proponents to proceed to Stage 2.

Criteria	Key considerations	Weighting
1. Proponent Capability & Experience	Demonstrated success in operating high-quality caravan parks or tourism assets. Stability of management and depth of industry expertise.	35%
2. Vision & Strategic Alignment	Alignment with Council's strategic goals for regional growth and tourism activation.	30%
3. Concept Innovation & Quality	The suitability and creativity of the proposed accommodation mix and activation concepts.	20%
4. Financial & Commercial Logic	Clarity of lease term preferences and a high-level commercial approach that suggests project viability and long-term sustainability.	15%

Note: Council reserves the right to request further information or clarification during the evaluation process.

9. Stage 2: Request for Detailed Proposals (RFDP) Scope

****Only Shortlisted Proponents will be invited to submit a detailed, technical, and financially binding proposal addressing the following criteria****

1. Detailed Capacity and Financial Position

- Provide detailed resumes of the key management team and operational staff.
- Demonstrate financial capacity to fund the proposed capital works, including bank references or proof of funding.

2. Detailed Accommodation Strategy

- Finalise the proposed accommodation types, providing specific numbers for powered/unpowered sites, cabins (including disability accessible units), glamping, and annual agreement offerings.
- Provide a definitive timeline and staging plan for the delivery of all accommodation units.

3. Guest Services and Operational Management

- Detail the full suite of guest services, amenities, and recreational offerings.
- Provide a comprehensive plan covering: reception operations, communal facility maintenance, and digital service platforms.
- Describe the specific strategies to increase occupancy and improve the visitor experience year-round.

4. Development and Capital Investment Plan

- Present a comprehensive concept development plan and site masterplan.
- Provide detailed capital investment estimates, broken down by stage and infrastructure type.
- Outline the proposed tariffs, pricing strategy, and guest value proposition.
- Demonstrate full alignment with planning controls, environmental obligations, and Crown Land management requirements.

5. Binding Financial Offer

- State the proposed base annual rent (exclusive of GST) for both Crown and Council owned components of land and the preferred review schedule (CPI or fixed %).
- Clarify the ownership structure of assets and provide a clear "exit strategy" for the transfer or removal of assets at the end of the lease.
- Commit to a specific maintenance fund percentage for the upkeep of communal infrastructure.

6. Strategic Marketing and Regional Integration

- Provide a detailed marketing and branding strategy, including digital engagement plans.

- Outline specific proposed partnerships with regional tourism (e.g., North of the Murray)
- Include a calendar of seasonal activation, event hosting, and community engagement strategies.

7. Compliance and Risk Management

- Provide a detailed risk management plan for park operations and capital works.
- Demonstrate how all commercial activities will be managed to ensure safety, compliance, and community benefit.

Note: *Further information and detailed project requirements will be disclosed to invited proponents during the next phase*

10. Site Inspection and Questions & Enquiries

Prospective proponents are strongly encouraged to attend the formal on-site inspection, which will be the sole opportunity for a scheduled viewing.

The site inspection will be held on:

Wednesday 3rd June, 2026 - 11am

Onsite, Ball Park Caravan Park - 2026-305

Bridge Road, Corowa

RSVP – narelle.donovan@federationcouncil.nsw.gov.au by Friday 29th May, 2026

All enquiries or requests for further information regarding this opportunity should be directed in writing to:

Manager Community and Economic Development – Narelle Donovan

Phone: (02) 6033 8999

Email: narelle.donovan@federationcouncil.nsw.gov.au

11. Lodging your Submission

Expression of Interest submissions must be lodged by the closing date.

Closing Date: Friday 26th June, 2026

Proposals are to be submitted electronically via councils online tender platform e-procure.

The link is below:

[How to Register with eProcure - Federation Council](#)

SCHEDULE A: Respondents Contact Details

Respondent's name (in full)	
Address of registered office	
Suburb State Postcode	
Postal address	
Suburb State Postcode	
Australian Business Number (ABN)	
Respondent's Representative	
(The respondent's point of contact during the EOI evaluation period.)	
Name of respondent's representative	
Postal address	
Suburb State Postcode	
Business telephone Mobile	

Confirmation

By submitting a response to this Expression of Interest (EOI), the respondent confirms and warrants that:

1. All issued addenda have been received, reviewed, and incorporated into the response.
2. The respondent agrees to be bound by and comply with the terms and conditions of this EOI.
3. The respondent has no actual or potential conflicts of interest and is not aware of any circumstances that may give rise to such conflicts.
4. The respondent is not a related respondent as defined in relevant procurement guidelines.
5. The response is based solely on the respondent's own investigations and assessments.
6. The information provided in the response is complete, accurate, and contains all material required by the EOI.
7. The respondent and its associated entities are willing and able to:
 - Sign confidentiality undertakings and a probity and process deed as required by Council.
 - Commit the necessary human and financial resources to participate in the Request for Detailed Proposals (RFDP) process, if invited.

The respondent further agrees that the information contained in its response will remain valid for a period of 90 days from the closing date of this EOI.

I/we hereby submit a response to the Ball Park Caravan Park expressions of interest and agree to be bound by all conditions contained herein.		
Authorised on behalf of the Proponent by (authorised person's signature)		
Name:	Position:	Date:

SCHEDULE B: Response to Evaluation Criteria

Respondents are required to address each of the selection criteria outlined in:

Item 7. Scope of Proposal, and

Item 8. Evaluation Criteria of this document.

Responses must:

- Be no longer than 10 pages in total (excluding any appendices or supporting documentation).
- Clearly demonstrate how the proposal aligns with and advances Council's stated strategic objectives for Ball Park Caravan Park, as detailed in Section 5 – Strategic Objectives.
- Provide evidence-based responses that reflect the respondent's capability, experience, and proposed approach to delivering high-quality outcomes.
- Council encourages respondents to be concise, strategic, and outcome-focused in their submissions.

SCHEDULE C: Supporting Documentation

To assist proponents, the following documents are available in the Electronic Data Room via Councils procurement portal:

- a. Approval to Operate Caravan Park – Ball Park Caravan Park S68-2026-4513
- b. Stamped Plans – ATO Ball Park Caravan Park 19.2026.1029.1
- c. 19 78045 - Ball Park Caravan Park Masterplan & Business Case - Public Nov 2019 EOI
- d. Flood Study
- e. Draft Lease Agreement
- f. Ball Park Caravan Park - Financials
- g. RMS Occupancy Report (FY2025)

12. General Terms and Conditions

1. **Compliance with Conditions:** By lodging a response, a respondent represents and warrants that it accepts the conditions outlined herein. Council may, at its absolute discretion, reject proposals that do not comply with the requirements of this EOI.
2. **Late Submissions:** Council reserves the right to accept or reject late submissions at its absolute discretion.
3. **Incomplete Expressions of Interest:** Submissions that do not include all required information or are incomplete may be rejected.
4. **Extension of Deadline:** Council may, in its absolute discretion, extend the deadline for lodgment by notice on Council's website or directly to prospective proponents.
5. **Unauthorised Communication:** Proponents must direct all communications through the designated contact person. Canvassing or any contact with Councilors or Council staff in relation to this EOI will automatically disqualify a respondent.
6. **Enquiries and Clarifications:** Seek clarification in writing to assigned Council officer not less than seven days prior to the deadline. Responses (excluding proprietary information) will be shared with all prospective proponents.
7. **Addenda:** Council reserves the right to change any part of this EOI. Written addenda issued before the deadline will become part of this EOI document.
8. **No Process Contract:** This EOI is not a legal offer or a tender process and does not constitute a process contract. Council is not legally bound to proponents and is not obliged to proceed further with the process.
9. **Information Accuracy:** While Council has endeavoured to provide accurate information, no warranty or representation is made as to the accuracy of the information provided. Proponents must rely on their own enquiries.
10. **Costs:** All costs and expenses incurred by a respondent in preparing an EOI are borne solely by the respondent. Council is not liable for any costs or losses arising from this process.
11. **Council Costs:** The successful respondent will be responsible for all costs and expenses of Council in the preparation, negotiation, and administration of contract documents (including legal costs) unless otherwise negotiated.
12. Council reserves the right, in its absolute discretion and without assigned reasons, to:
 - a. Not proceed with the EOI or evaluation process.
 - b. Suspend, vary, or change the structure and timing of the EOI.
 - c. Terminate participation by any respondent or terminate negotiations at any time.
 - d. Require additional information or negotiate with one or more proponents.
 - e. Modify any aspect of the EOI, including objectives and evaluation processes.

13. **Intellectual Property:** Proposals become the property of Council on submission. However, specific IP identified by the respondent will remain the property of the respondent. Council may use proposal material for the purposes of evaluating and pursuing the site redevelopment.
14. **GIPA Act:** Proposals are subject to the *Government Information (Public Access) Act 2009* (NSW). Council may be required to disclose information under this Act. Commercially sensitive information should be clearly marked "Commercial and Confidential," though this does not guarantee non-disclosure under the Act.
15. **Disclosure of Contract:** Council is required to disclose details of contracts exceeding \$150,000 in value.
16. **No Collusion:** Proponents must not engage in improper commercial arrangements, collusive tendering, or anti-competitive conduct. Engaging in such conduct will result in exclusion from the process.
17. **Material Change:** Proponents must promptly inform Council officers of any material change to their financial or technical capacity or corporate status following lodgment.
18. **Consortium Membership:** If consortium membership changes after lodgment, Council reserves the right to re-evaluate or withdraw the respondent based on the diminished capability of the new structure.



**FEDERATION
COUNCIL**

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'SUMMER DAYS' COROWA LAGOON - ADJACENT TO CARAVAN PARK